

Should & Ought to

CEFR A2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

'Should', 'ought to' and 'had better' all give advice, with small differences:

- 1 Should — everyday advice and the right thing to do (You should rest).
- 2 Ought to — the same, slightly more formal (You ought to apologise).
- 3 Had better — a strong warning (You'd better hurry).

'Should' takes the base verb (should go). For past advice or regret, use 'should have + past participle': You should have told me.

At a glance

Meaning	Form	Example
Everyday advice	should + base verb	You should drink more water.
Slightly formal advice	ought to + base verb	You ought to thank her.
Advice with a warning	had better ('d better) + base verb	You'd better leave now.
Past advice / regret	should have + past participle	You should have called.

Learning objectives

- Can use 'should' and 'shouldn't' to give advice (CEFR A2).
- Can use 'ought to' and 'had better' with the right register and strength.
- Can use 'should have + past participle' for past advice and regret.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Should & Ought to · CEFR A2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. You look tired. You ____ get some rest.

- A. should
- C. shoulds

- B. should to
- D. must to

2. It's raining hard. You ____ take an umbrella.

- A. shouldn't
- C. should have

- B. should
- D. ought

3. You ____ apologise to her; it would be the polite thing.

- A. ought to
- C. should to

- B. ought
- D. oughts to

4. We ____ hurry, or we'll miss the last train.

- A. should have
- C. ought

- B. 'd better
- D. shouldn't

5. I feel sick. — You ____ eaten so much cake.

- A. shouldn't have
- C. don't have to

- B. shouldn't
- D. ought

6. You ____ worry so much; everything will be fine.

- A. shouldn't
- C. ought to

- B. should
- D. had better

7. He failed the test. He ____ harder.

- A. should study
- C. ought study

- B. should have studied
- D. had better study

8. Correct this: 'You should to see a dentist.'

- A. You should see a dentist.
- C. You should seeing a dentist.

- B. You shoulds see a dentist.
- D. The sentence is already correct.

9. This milk smells bad. You ____ drink it.

- A. should
- C. 'd better not

- B. ought to
- D. should have

10. Which sentence gives advice about the PAST?

- A. You should call your mother.
- C. You should have told me sooner.

- B. You ought to be careful.
- D. You'd better leave now.

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. should** — Advice takes 'should' + base verb: 'You should get some rest'.
2. **B. should** — Positive advice takes 'should': 'You should take an umbrella'.
3. **A. ought to** — 'Ought to' keeps 'to': 'You ought to apologise'.
4. **B. 'd better** — A warning takes 'had better': 'We'd better hurry'.
5. **A. shouldn't have** — Past regret takes 'shouldn't have + participle': 'You shouldn't have eaten so much'.
6. **A. shouldn't** — Advising against something takes 'shouldn't': 'You shouldn't worry'.
7. **B. should have studied** — Past regret takes 'should have + participle': 'He should have studied harder'.
8. **A. You should see a dentist.** — 'Should' takes the base verb: 'You should see a dentist'.
9. **C. 'd better not** — A warning against it takes "'d better not": 'You'd better not drink it'.
10. **C. You should have told me sooner.** — 'Should have told' is advice/regret about the past.